

CSS Positioning

http://www.w3schools.com/Css/css_positioning.asp

Elements can be positioned using the **top**, **bottom**, **left**, and **right** properties. However, these properties will not work unless the **position** property is set first.

There are four different positioning methods.

Floating and display:inline are also used.

(1) Static Positioning

HTML elements are positioned **static** by **default**. A static positioned element is always positioned according to the normal flow of the page.

Static positioned elements are not affected by the top, bottom, left, and right properties.

(2) Fixed Positioning

An element with fixed position is positioned **relative to the browser window**.

It will not move even if the window is scrolled:

Example

```
p.pos_fixed
{
    position: fixed;
    top:      30px;
    right:     5px;
}
```

Note: Internet Explorer supports the fixed value only if a !DOCTYPE is specified.

Fixed positioned elements are removed from the normal flow. The document and other elements behave like the fixed positioned element does not exist.

Fixed positioned elements can overlap other elements.

(3) Relative Positioning

A relative positioned element is positioned relative to its normal position (static flow position).

Example

```
h2.pos_left
{
    position: relative;
    left:     -20px;
}

h2.pos_right
{
    position: relative;
    left:     20px;
}
```

The content of a relatively positioned elements can be moved and overlap other elements, but the reserved space for the element is still preserved in the normal flow.

Example

```
h2.pos_top
{
    position: relative;
    top:      -50px;
}
```

Relatively positioned elements are often used as containers for absolutely positioned elements.

(4) Absolute Positioning

An absolute position element is positioned relative to the first parent element that has a position other than static. If no such element is found, the containing block is <html>:

Example

```
h2
{
    position: absolute;
    left:     100px;
    top:      150px;
```

```
}
```

Absolutely positioned elements are removed from the normal flow. The document and other elements behave like the absolutely positioned element does not exist.

Absolutely positioned elements can overlap other elements.

(5) Overlapping Elements

When elements are positioned outside the normal flow, they can overlap other elements.

The z-index property specifies the stack order of an element (which element should be placed in front of, or behind, the others).

An element can have a positive or negative stack order:

Example

```
img
{
    position: absolute;
    left:    0px;
    top:     0px;
    z-index: -1;
}
```

An element with greater stack order is always in front of an element with a lower stack order.

(6) Display Inline

The element is displayed inline, inside the current block on the same line.

Example

```
div.inline
{
    display: inline;
}
```

(7) Float

The element is displayed inline, inside the current block on the same line.

Example

```
div.float-left {
    float: left;
    width: 100px;
    height: 50px;

    background-color: coral;
    border: 2px solid black;
}

div.float-right {
    float: right;

    width: 100px;
    height: 50px;

    background-color: coral;
    border: 2px solid black;
}

div.float-center {

    margin-left: 100px;
    margin-right: 100px;

    height: 50px;

    background-color: coral;
    border: 2px dashed black;
}
```

```
<div>
  <div class="float-left">
    <p>float-left</p>
  </div>

  <div class="float-right">
    <p>float-right</p>
  </div>

  <div class="float-center">
    <p>float-center</p>
  </div>
</div>
```